

BARBERBOOK.MA

Business Model & Business Model Canvas

*Incubator-ready submission document for a Moroccan vertical SaaS + marketplace startup
in the grooming industry*

Submission Purpose

This document presents a structured business model for BarberBook.ma, including the problem, solution, target market, monetization strategy, go-to-market plan, operating model, roadmap, key risks, and a full Business Model Canvas.

It is designed to support incubation, acceleration, early fundraising discussions, and strategic execution planning.

Project

BarberBook.ma

Prepared for

Incubator / accelerator review

Prepared as a practical, execution-focused business model for the Moroccan market

1. Executive Summary

BarberBook.ma is a vertical SaaS and marketplace platform designed for barbershops in Morocco. The company addresses a highly fragmented and still largely manual market where booking, customer management, and shop discovery are often handled through phone calls, walk-ins, notebooks, and WhatsApp messages. The platform gives barbershops a digital operating layer to manage appointments, services, staff, and customer relationships, while also giving end customers a simple way to discover barbershops, compare profiles, and book appointments online.

The strategic thesis is to start as a SaaS-first operating system for barbershops, then progressively layer on marketplace discovery, reviews, customer retention tools, and monetization through prepaid access packs, business credits, booking-linked fees, promoted visibility, and premium add-ons. This creates a business with predictable revenue behavior, strong retention potential, and increasing network effects as city-level supply density grows.

Core Opportunity

- Digitize a high-frequency service category with fragmented supply and recurring customer demand.
- Create value for both merchants and consumers through one integrated platform.
- Build predictable prepaid software revenue before scaling marketplace monetization.

Why Now

- Consumers increasingly expect convenience, transparency, and online booking.
- Barbershops need better organization, reduced no-shows, and stronger retention.
- A local, WhatsApp-friendly and culturally adapted solution can outperform generic tools.

2. Company Vision, Mission and Positioning

- **Vision:** To become the leading digital operating system and discovery platform for barbershops across Morocco, then North Africa.
- **Mission:** Help barbershops run better businesses and help customers book trusted grooming services more easily.
- **Positioning:** BarberBook.ma is not only a booking app; it is a growth and operations platform tailored to the realities of the Moroccan grooming market.

Positioning statement: “BarberBook.ma helps Moroccan barbershops manage appointments, staff and customers while getting discovered and booked online.”

3. Problem Statement

The current barbershop experience in Morocco is inefficient for both merchants and customers. On the supply side, many shops still rely on manual scheduling and informal customer management.

On the demand side, customers often lack visibility into quality, pricing, availability, and waiting time.

Stakeholder	Pain Point	Business Impact
Barbershop owner	Appointments managed manually through calls, messages or walk-ins	Missed bookings, double-bookings and scheduling chaos
Barbershop owner	Little or no customer history and retention workflow	Low repeat rate and poor customer lifetime value
Customer	No simple way to compare shops, services and prices	Friction in discovery and low trust before booking
Customer	Long waiting times or uncertain availability	Poor experience and lost demand
Market	No specialized barber-focused discovery and review layer	Fragmented market with weak digital visibility

4. Solution Overview

BarberBook.ma solves these problems with a two-sided platform: a merchant operating dashboard for barbershops and a customer-facing booking and discovery experience. The initial wedge is operational value for the merchant, because solving scheduling and customer management pain is the fastest path to adoption and revenue.

Merchant-side Value

- Appointment calendar and booking management
- Services, pricing and staff scheduling
- Customer records and visit history
- Automated reminders and confirmations
- Basic analytics and performance visibility
- Public booking page and marketplace listing

Customer-side Value

- Search shops by city or neighborhood
- View profiles, services, prices and photos
- Read reviews and compare options
- Choose barber, service and time slot
- Book online without calling the shop

5. Market Focus and Customer Segments

The business should launch with a focused urban go-to-market strategy rather than spreading resources too early. The first priority is city density, not national breadth. Casablanca should be the

initial launch market, followed by Rabat and Marrakech once the onboarding and retention playbook is proven.

Segment	Profile	Why it matters
Primary merchant ICP	Independent and modern barbershops with 2 to 6 chairs in major cities	Higher willingness to pay and easier operational adoption
Secondary merchant ICP	Premium shops and growing chains	Higher ARPU and demand for analytics / CRM
End customer	Urban, mobile-first men seeking convenience and trusted quality	Drives repeat booking frequency and marketplace demand
Expansion market	Tunisia and Algeria after Moroccan city traction	Regional adjacency once product and GTM are validated

6. Product Scope and MVP

To maximize speed and validation, the MVP should focus on one workflow: transforming phone and WhatsApp booking chaos into an organized calendar with customer records and a shareable booking link. Anything that does not directly improve booking operations or merchant activation should be postponed.

Build in MVP	Description	Priority
Shop profile	Name, address, services, pricing, opening hours, staff and photos	Must-have
Booking calendar	Create, edit, confirm, cancel and assign appointments	Must-have
Customer CRM lite	Phone number, visit history, notes and preferences	Must-have
Notifications	Confirmation and reminder workflow through WhatsApp or SMS	Must-have
Public booking page	Shareable merchant page for Instagram bio and direct traffic	Must-have
Basic analytics	Bookings, repeat customers, no-shows and top services	Should-have

Build in MVP	Description	Priority
Reviews and promos	Customer reviews and marketing offers	Post-MVP
Advanced payments and loyalty	Deposits, memberships, advanced automation	Later-stage

7. Business Model and Revenue Streams

BarberBook.ma should operate with a hybrid business model built around prepaid software access, usage-based business credits, and transaction-linked promotional monetization. In the early stage, prepaid access packs should be the primary engine because they are easier to explain to merchants, reduce payment friction, and do not depend on marketplace liquidity. Marketplace monetization should be layered in progressively as the supply base and customer demand increase.

Revenue Stream	Mechanism	Strategic Role
Prepaid access packs	30-day, 90-day, or annual prepaid software access for barbershops	Core early revenue and retention anchor
Business credits	Rechargeable credits for reminders, campaigns, seats, or premium features	Flexible upsell tied to visible merchant value
Booking-linked fees	Small fee on platform-generated or prepaid bookings	Scales with demand and booking volume
Featured listings	Paid visibility in search results, city pages and campaigns	Monetizes merchant demand for growth
Enterprise packs	Custom prepaid packages for chains or multi-branch operations	Higher contract value and defensibility
Future partnerships	Brand promotions, grooming products and sponsorships	Longer-term ancillary monetization

8. Pricing Strategy

Pricing must balance accessibility for small merchants with enough perceived value to support a healthy business. The recommended commercial logic is to sell prepaid 30-day access packs and optional business credits rather than rely on automatic subscriptions. One or two additional retained customers per month should still more than pay for the platform, which keeps the offer easy to justify to shop owners while matching local payment behavior.

Plan	Target user	Included value	Indicative Price
Free	Trial / very small shops	Limited bookings, one barber, public profile, basic page	MAD 0
Basic Access Pack	Entry-level independent shops	30-day access, one barber, booking calendar, services, customer list, public page	MAD 99 / 30 days
Growth Access Pack	Most independent shops	30-day access, multiple barbers, unlimited internal bookings, CRM lite, reminders, analytics basics	MAD 199 / 30 days
Pro Access Pack	Growth-oriented shops	30-day access, advanced analytics, reviews, reactivation tools, featured visibility support, richer CRM	MAD 349 / 30 days
Enterprise Pack	Chains / multi-branch operators	Custom prepaid package with multi-location control, reporting, onboarding and support	Custom pricing

- Pricing principle 1: Keep the initial setup friction low with a free pilot, manual onboarding, and simple prepaid renewal.

- Pricing principle 2: Use prepaid 30-day access packs as the base offer, then layer on usage credits only where value is obvious.
- Pricing principle 3: Use add-ons, reminders, and featured visibility credits to grow ARPU without over-complicating the core plans.

9. Go-to-Market Strategy

The recommended go-to-market motion is supply-first, city-by-city, and founder-led. The business should not begin by spending aggressively on consumer demand. Instead, it should first acquire barbershops, make them active on the software, and turn each merchant into a distribution node through booking links, QR codes and rebooking behavior.

Phase	Objective	Recommended actions
Phase 1	Acquire first merchants in Casablanca	Founder-led sales, field visits, Instagram / WhatsApp outreach, manual onboarding
Phase 2	Increase merchant activation and retention	Booking links in bios, staff usage training, reminders, onboarding support
Phase 3	Start demand generation in dense neighborhoods	Reviews, local SEO pages, referral programs, customer rebooking flows
Phase 4	Expand to Rabat and Marrakech	Replicate onboarding playbook and target similar merchant profiles

10. Operating Model

As an early-stage company, BarberBook.ma should operate leanly. The founder or a very small team should control sales, onboarding, support and product learning as closely as possible. Early operations should be highly manual where needed because manual work provides insight and is often faster than overbuilding product infrastructure too soon.

Early Operating Priorities

- Founder-led merchant acquisition
- Manual onboarding and setup for first shops
- Weekly product iteration from direct user

Core Operating Capabilities

- Product development and maintenance
- Merchant onboarding and training
- Customer support and issue resolution
- Basic analytics, billing and campaign operations

feedback

- Support through WhatsApp and lightweight help flows

11. Growth Strategy and Network Effects

The business has the potential to create reinforcing growth loops. Each onboarded barbershop can distribute its booking page to existing customers. Every completed booking can generate a rebooking trigger, review request or referral. As more shops and reviews accumulate, customer discovery improves, which in turn increases merchant value and willingness to pay for visibility and CRM tools.

Growth Loop	How it works	Expected effect
Merchant distribution loop	Shops share their booking links through Instagram, WhatsApp and in-store QR codes	Low-cost customer acquisition and merchant activation
Rebooking loop	Completed visits trigger reminders and repeat booking prompts	Higher customer retention and recurring usage
Review loop	Satisfied customers leave reviews after appointments	Increased trust and better marketplace conversion
Merchant referral loop	Existing shops refer other barbershops in exchange for credits or promotion	Lower merchant acquisition cost
Portfolio loop	Barbers showcase styles and results on profiles	Improved discovery and social sharing

12. Roadmap: 0 to 1 to Scale

Stage	Main objective	Key milestones
0 – Validation	Prove problem intensity and willingness to pay	Interview 30 shops, onboard 5–10 pilots, validate weekly usage and first payments
1 – MVP launch	Ship core product and start paid prepaid usage	Calendar, CRM lite, booking page, reminders, 10+ paying

Stage	Main objective	Key milestones
		shops on prepaid packs
2 – Product-market fit signals	Improve retention and expand supply density	50 paying shops, strong repeat usage, reviews and referral motion
3 – Marketplace ignition	Generate meaningful customer discovery demand	Payments, chains, richer analytics, Tunisia / Algeria validation, stronger credit-based upsells
4 – Scale	Expand cities and deepen monetization	Payments, chains, richer analytics, Tunisia / Algeria validation

13. Key Risks and Mitigation Plan

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Low merchant adoption	Shops may resist changing habits or paying for software	Target digitally active premium shops first and keep onboarding extremely simple
Marketplace liquidity challenge	Without enough supply and demand, the marketplace may feel empty	Start SaaS-first and build city-level density before heavy consumer acquisition
No-shows and booking trust	Poor booking reliability reduces merchant confidence	Use reminders, confirmation logic, cancellation rules and later deposits
Overbuilding too early	A small team can lose time on unnecessary features	Keep MVP narrow and prioritize workflows tied directly to activation and revenue
Price sensitivity	Some shops may have low willingness to pay	Use affordable prepaid entry packs, manual renewal support, and prove ROI through repeat customers and better organization

14. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

The early company should focus on operational KPIs that directly measure real merchant usage and monetization. Vanity metrics such as app visits or social media views should be secondary to active shops, completed bookings and repeat customer behavior.

KPI Category	Core metrics to track
Merchant acquisition	Shops onboarded, activated shops, paying shops, activation rate
Usage	Bookings per active shop, completed bookings, no-show rate, share of online-originated bookings
Retention	30-day merchant retention, repeat booking rate, returning customer share
Revenue	Monthly collected revenue, ARPU, add-on attach rate, prepaid renewal rate, take rate on monetized bookings
Operations	Onboarding time per shop, support load, reminder delivery success rate

Recommended early north-star metric: completed bookings per active shop per month.

15. Business Model Canvas (BMC)

Complete canvas summary for incubator review

BMC Block	BarberBook.ma
Customer Segments	Independent barbershop owners, premium shops, growing chains, urban male consumers seeking grooming services
Value Proposition	Operational efficiency for shops; better discovery, trust and booking convenience for customers
Channels	Founder-led sales, website, mobile web, WhatsApp, Instagram, referrals, QR codes, SEO city pages
Customer Relationships	Assisted onboarding, self-service booking, support via chat/WhatsApp, automated reminders and rebooking

BMC Block	BarberBook.ma
Revenue Streams	Prepaid access packs, business credits, booking-linked fees, featured listings, enterprise packs, future partnerships
Key Resources	Software platform, merchant network, customer and booking data, brand, product capability, support processes
Key Activities	Product development, onboarding, support, sales, marketplace growth, billing, analytics and retention campaigns
Key Partners	Payment providers, messaging providers, barber schools, influencers, cloud vendors, local brand partners
Cost Structure	Product development, hosting, messaging, payment processing, support, sales and marketing, admin and operations

16. Conclusion

BarberBook.ma combines clear merchant value with strong marketplace upside. The most credible path is to win first with operational software, build density in one city, and then expand into discovery, retention and broader monetization. This makes the project practical, scalable and well suited for incubator support.